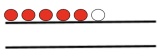
Kindergarten Weekly Newsletter

Week of February 2, 2026

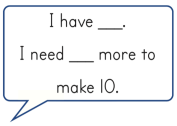
Math

Our mathematicians have been building their fact fluency to 10. This week, our students will find the number that makes 10 when added to a given number! We will use ten frames and rekenreks as manipulatives.

Show the number on the rekenrek



How many more to get to ten?



6 + 4 = 10

At home, give your child a number less than 10 and ask them: how many more to get to 10?

Literacy

In Literacy, we are reading the text The Three Billy Goats Gruff. In this story, the three billy goats are trying to cross the bridge to get to the meadow to eat grass. But, underneath the bridge, there is a mean, ugly troll who wants to gobble them up! Ask your child to retell you the story to find out what happens!

In Fundations, students will continue to study "trick words" in sentences. Trick words are what we call sight words or high frequency words. They are called trick words because they have a tricky part so we cannot tap them out.

At home, read through books with your child and have them find trick words that we have learned so far: **me, the, in.**

News/Reminders

A message from the Sustainability Team:

Wednesday, February 4th is **Energy Climate Action Day!** We'll be talking about clean energy in school and each class will be participating in one period of Lights Out! **Please wear red** on this day to celebrate and support.

Acadience Screener Reports:

Your child's Acadience Reading and Math middle of year screener results have been sent home. Attached you'll find a short explanation of the screener and the grade-level benchmarks for your child's grade level. Please take a moment to review it!

Dates

- **Monday, 2/2** - School Spirit Day - wear 217 shirt or colors (**yellow/purple**), order HERE
- **Wednesday, 2/4** - Energy Climate Action Day, **wear red**
- **Friday, 2/6 -** Kindergarten Alphabet Celebration, 8:30-9:10am
- **Friday, 2/13** - Valentine's Day Celebrations
- **Monday - Friday, 2/16 - 2/20** - NO SCHOOL
- **Monday, 2/23** - 100th Day of School
- **Thursday, 3/12** - HALF DAY, 11:20am dismissal for Virtual Parent-Teacher Conferences

Kindergarten Field Trip to Mount Vernon Hotel & Museum

- **K003 - Thursday, 3/5**
- **K001 - Friday, 3/13**
- **K004 - Thursday, 3/19**
- **K002 - Friday, 3/27**

App of the Month (February)

Scratch Junior

ScratchJr is an introductory programming language that enables young children (ages 5-7) to create their own interactive stories and games. Practicing computer science skills such as algorithms and loops will help your child while engaging in computer science lessons at school. Desktop download

Dear Kindergarten Families,

I want to share some exciting updates about our recent musical learning in class.

Our kindergarteners have been developing their group singing skills, learning to listen to each other and blend their voices together. When students sing as a group, they practice important musical skills like matching pitch, following a steady beat, and listening to others. These early experiences with group singing help develop their ears and vocal control while building confidence in their musical abilities.

Through guided listening activities, your students are learning to recognize when their voices are too loud or soft compared to their classmates. They're discovering how to adjust their volume to create a balanced group sound. This awareness not only helps develop their musicianship but also reinforces valuable social skills like cooperation and awareness of others.

We've also been exploring basic rhythmic notation using the Kodály method, a proven approach to music education. Students are learning to read, write, and perform simple rhythm patterns using words and syllables that naturally connect to the rhythms they're learning. For example, they're discovering how certain words have long and short sounds, and how these sounds relate to musical notation. This method makes complex musical concepts accessible and enjoyable for young learners.

The Kodály approach helps students internalize rhythm through natural learning sequences. By connecting rhythm to language and movement, students develop a strong foundation in musical literacy. These skills support not only their musical development but also reinforce language development, pattern recognition, and mathematical thinking—all essential skills for kindergarten learners.

As we continue through the year, I'll build upon these foundational experiences in singing and rhythm. Students will expand their repertoire of songs, learn more complex rhythm patterns, and continue developing the listening and coordination skills that form the basis of musical understanding. The progress your students are making demonstrates their growing musicality and readiness for more advanced concepts.

Best regards,

Vincent Ladalia

Music Teacher, PS/IS 217